TODD R. JONES

trj234@msstate.edu ◇ toddrjones.com
Mississippi State University, 312D McCool Hall
Mississippi State, MS 39762

PRIMARY POSITION

Associate Professor of Economics, Mississippi State University	2026–
Assistant Professor of Economics, Mississippi State University	2020-2026

AFFILIATIONS AND APPOINTMENTS

Editorial Board, Education Finance and Policy	2026–
IZA Research Fellow	2025–
Visiting Scholar, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago	2024–
CESifo Research Network Affiliate	2023–
EdWorkingPapers Invited Contributor	2020–
IZA Research Affiliate	2021–2025
Guest Researcher, CESifo, Center for the Economics of Education	1/2023
Postdoc, Georgia Policy Labs, Georgia State University	2018–2020

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Economics, Cornell University	2018
M.A., Economics, Cornell University	2016
M.S., Statistics, Utah State University	2012
B.A., Economics, Utah State University, *Summa Cum Laude*	2011
Minors: Mathematics, Chinese	
Chinese Language, Shanghai JiaoTong University, China	2007

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Microeconomics, Economics of Education, Time Use, Economics of the Family, Labor Economics, Economics of Crime, Science of Science

WORKING PAPERS

1. School and Crime (with Ezra Karger). *Reject and resubmit, AEJ: Economic Policy.*
2. Forecasting the Economic Impacts of AI (with Ezra Karger, Otto Kuusela, Jason Abaluck, Kevin Bryan, Basil Halperin, Connacher Murphy, Phil Trammell, Matt Reynolds, Dan Mayland, Ria Viswanathan, Ananaya Mittal, Rebecca Ceppas de Castro, Josh Rosenberg, and Philip Tetlock).
3. Cheaper by the Dozen: Parental Time Use and Returns to Scale in Raising Children (with Ezra Karger and Valerie Michelman).
4. Social Substitution?: Time Use Responses to Increased Workplace Isolation (with Benjamin Cowan). Conditional Acceptance, *Economic Inquiry.*
5. Paying for Prestige: Compensating Differentials in Faculty Job Choice (with Alex Bell). Draft available upon request.

PUBLICATIONS

6. First Generation College Students and Peer Effects. *Labour Economics* (2025), 102768. (Joint with Michael Kofoed.)
7. The Academic Origins of Economics Faculty. *Journal of Economic Education* (2024), 55(4), 434-454. (Joint with Arielle Sloan.)
8. Parental and Student Time Use Around the Academic Year. *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization* (2024), 224: 66-110. (Joint with Benjamin Cowan and Jeffrey Swigert.)
9. Changes in Parental Gender Preference in the United States: Evidence from 1850-2019. *Journal of Population Economics* (2023), 36: 3057–3070. (Joint with Matthew Millington and Joseph Price.)
10. The Graduate School Origins of Finance Faculty. *Journal of Empirical Finance* (2023), 71:88-103. (Joint with Haoyang Xiong)
11. The Effects of Financial Aid Loss on Student Persistence and Graduation: A Multi-Dimensional Regression Discontinuity Approach. *Education Finance and Policy* (2022), 17(2): 206-231. (Joint with Daniel Kreisman, Ross Rubenstein, Cynthia Searcy, and Rachana Bhatt.)
12. Maxed Out: The Human Capital Effects of Larger Student Loan Limits. *Journal of Human Resources* (2021), 56 (4): 1113-1140. (Joint with Jeffrey Denning.)
13. College Credit on the Table? Advanced Placement Course and Exam Taking. *Economics of Education Review* (2021), 84: 102-155. (Joint with Ishtiaque Fazlul and Jonathan Smith.)
14. Do Peers Influence Occupational Preferences? Evidence from Randomly-Assigned Peer Groups at West Point. *Journal of Public Economics* (2020), 184: 104-154. (Joint with Michael Kofoed.)
15. Are High-Quality PhD Programs at Universities Associated with More Undergraduate Students Pursuing PhD Study? *Education Economics* (2019), 27(5):451-471. (Joint with Ronald Ehrenberg.)
16. Information and the Beauty Premium in Political Elections. *Contemporary Economic Policy* (2017), 35: 677-683. (Joint with Joseph Price.)
17. SigTree: A Microbial Community Analysis Tool to Identify and Visualize Significantly Responsive Branches in a Phylogenetic Tree. *Computational and Structural Biotechnology Journal* (2017), 15:372-378. (Joint with John Stevens, Michael Lefevre, Balasubramanian Ganesan, and Bart Weimer.)

WORKS IN PROGRESS

18. The Morphology of Crime (with Benjamin Cowan and Ezra Karger).
19. Conferences and Coauthors (with Ezra Karger).
20. The Effects of School and Non-school Resources on Student Outcomes (with Ezra Karger and Sarah Komisarow).
21. Outcomes of Ph.D. Economists (with Ezra Karger).

BOOK

22. Quick Stata Tips. This is a self-published book containing 140 Stata tips.

OTHER WRITING

23. The Political Geography of AI Exposure. *Brookings*, 2026. (Joint with Mark Muro and Shriya Methkupally.)

24. Moms Lose Significant Sleep and Free Time During Kids' School Year, New Study Finds. *The Conversation*, 2023. (Joint with Benjamin Cowan and Jeffrey Swigert.) Also appears in Fortune and PBS.

25. Taking Advanced Placement Courses but Not the Exam. *Metro Atlanta Policy Lab for Education, Georgia Policy Labs*, 2020. (Joint with Ishtiaque Fazlul and Jonathan Smith.)

26. Post-Secondary Financial Aid Foundational Report: 2013-14 to 2018-19. *Child & Family Policy Lab, Georgia Policy Labs*, 2020.

RESEARCH RESOURCES

27. Datasets. This is a compilation on GitHub of 100+ free datasets that may be useful for social science and applied microeconomic research.

PRESENTATIONS (INCLUDING SCHEDULED)

2027: University of Alabama **2026**: AEA Meeting (by coauthor), Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas, Congressional Budget Office (by coauthor), OpenAI (by coauthor), NBER Summer Institute Forecasting & Empirical Methods (by coauthor) **2025**: NBER Summer Institute GITE (by coauthor), Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, Temple University (by coauthor) **2024**: ASSA Meetings (SGE), University of Texas Rio Grande Valley, University of Memphis, University of Delaware (by coauthor), Mississippi State University **2023**: ifo Center for the Economics of Education, AEFP Meetings, APPAM Meetings, GLO-JOPE 2023 Global Conference (by coauthor) **2022**: AEFP Meetings, Atlanta Fed Southeastern Micro Labor Workshop, Mississippi State University, NBER Spring Education Meeting, NBER Spring Children's Meeting, University of Connecticut, University of South Carolina, APPAM Meetings (by coauthor), Southerns Meetings, University of Mississippi (canceled - sickness) **2021**: Mississippi State University Ag Econ, AEFP Meetings, Southerns Meetings **2020**: Mississippi State University, Southern Utah University, Ryerson University, San Diego State University, AEFP Meetings (two presentations by coauthors), Westerns Meetings (by coauthor), Georgia Policy Labs CFPL Equitable Access Webinar (panelist), APPAM Meetings (poster; and presentation by coauthor), Southerns Meetings **2019**: AEFP Meetings, Georgia State University Brownbag, European Association of Labour Economists Annual Conference (by coauthor), Georgia State University Ph.D. Seminar **2018**: Ohio State University, Georgia State University MAPLE **2017**: Cornell University **2016**: AEFP Meetings, Midwestern Economic Association/SOLE, Southerns Meetings (by coauthor) **2015**: Cornell University Economics of Education Meeting, Cornell University Labor Work in Progress Seminar, Southerns Meetings **2014**: Cornell University Economics of Education Meeting, Brigham Young University Graduate Student Conference, Utah State University, Cornell University Economics of Education Meeting

TEACHING

Instructor (including scheduled):

Principles of Microeconomics, Mississippi State University
S2021, F21 (x2), S22, F22 (x2), S23, F23 (x2), F24 (x2), S25, F25 (x2), S26, S27

Intermediate Microeconomics, Mississippi State University
F20 (x2), S21, S22, S23, S24 (x2), S25, S26, S27

Data Analytics Internship in Athletics, Mississippi State University
S23

Teaching Assistant:

Economic Analysis of the University, Cornell University, Ron Ehrenberg
F14, F16, F17

Introductory Microeconomics, Cornell University, Jennifer Wissink
F13, S14

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee:
Journal of Labor Economics (2), Journal of Human Resources (3), Journal of Public Economics, Journal of Population Economics (2), Journal of Policy Analysis and Management (2), Economics of Education Review (14), Education Finance and Policy (11), Health Economics, Economic Inquiry (2), Journal of Empirical Finance, ILR Review, Review of Economics of the Household (2), Southern Economic Journal (4), Contemporary Economic Policy (3), Journal of Economic Education (3), B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis and Policy, International Journal of Law & Economics

Department:

Seminar Series Co-Organizer, Mississippi State University	2022-
Applied Economics Research Group, Founder and Organizer, Mississippi State University	2021-
Journal Ranking Committee, Mississippi State University	2022-2023, 2024
Hiring Committee, Mississippi State University	2020-21, 2022, 2025
Interview Committee, Mississippi State University	2020-21, 2025

Conference Session Chair:

APPAM	2023
AEFP	2021, 2022
Southerns Meetings	2021

Conference Discussant:

Southeastern Micro Labor Workshop	2024
APPAM	2023
Southerns Meetings	2015, 2018 (x2), 2021 (x2), 2022
Midwestern Meetings	2016

Advising:

Ph.D. Committee Member, Haoyang Xiong, Mississippi State University 2022
Initial Placement: Assistant Professor of Finance, Montana State University

Helping Candidates Prepare for Job Market:
Association for Mentoring & Inclusion in Economics 2021–2023, 2025

MEDIA

Newspaper, Magazine, Blog, and Policy Interviews and References: Washington Post (August 20, 2026). Fortune (June 26, 2026). Financial Times (June 7, 2026). Fortune (June 4, 2026). The National News Desk (Sinclair Broadcast Group) (June 4, 2026). New York Times (April 30, 2026). Hutchins Roundup, Brookings (April 16, 2026). New York Times (April 3, 2026). Marginal Revolution (April 1, 2026). National Geographic (August 28, 2025). Chattanooga Times Free Press (December 12, 2024). Slate (May 10, 2023). KHN (March 22, 2021).

Podcasts: Bloomberg's Odd Lots podcast (Research mentioned, April 18, 2026). The Atlantic's Good on Paper podcast (Coauthor interviewed, September 24, 2024).

TV/Video Interviews: WTVA Mississippi (February 11, 2022; February 25, 2022; April 29, 2022); Mississippi State University College of Business Dividends Show (March 2021).

Other: My Stata tips were featured in Stata News 37-3. My graph was used in the 2024 State of the City address by the Mayor of Chattanooga. My paper was featured in FutureEd.

AWARDS

Price Theory Summer Camp, The Becker Friedman Institute, University of Chicago	2016
The Ernest Liu Family Outstanding Teaching Award, Field of Economics, Cornell University	2014

Sage Fellowship, Field of Economics, Cornell University 2012-13
Vice President For Research Fellowship, School of Graduate Studies, Utah State University 2011-12
National Advisory Board Scholarship, School of Business, Utah State University 2008-09, 2010-11
Seely-Hinckley Scholarship, School of Business, Utah State University 2009-10
Presidential Scholarship, Utah State University 2004-05, 2008-10
Eagle Scout Award 2002

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant:
Cornell: Ron Ehrenberg Summer 14, Spring 15-Summer 16, Summer 18
Cornell: Nick Sanders Spring-Summer 2017

Professional:
Statistics Intern, Autoliv, Ogden, UT Summer 2011
Statistics Intern, National Agricultural Statistical Service, Salt Lake City, Utah Summer 2010

PROGRAMMING

Stata, R, LaTeX

Developed *SigTree*, an R package (with John Stevens), available at CRAN

Data visualization: see http://www.toddrjones.com/dataviz

OTHER

Citizenship: USA
Languages: Swedish, Chinese (Basic)
Latter-day Saint Student Association, Advisor, Mississippi State University 2022–2024, 2026–

Last updated: October 13, 2026